

Participant Information Sheet

1. Title of Research Project and Researcher(s)

Context-Aware AI-Assisted Personal Reflection

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3. Invitation Paragraph

You are being invited to participate in a research study. Before you decide whether to participate, it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully and feel free to ask us if you would like more information or if there is anything that you do not understand. Please also feel free to discuss this with your friends, relatives, and doctor [where relevant] if you wish. We would like to stress that you do not have to accept this invitation and should only agree to take part if you want to.

Thank you for reading this.

4. What is the purpose of the study?

The purpose of this research is to design and evaluate AI-powered systems that help people reflect on their daily experiences, activities, digital behaviour, habits, goals, media consumption, or other non-clinical aspects of everyday life.

Many people use diaries, journals, note-taking tools, media histories, self-tracking tools, and AI chatbots to support reflection. However, these tools often require users to manually remember, describe, and interpret their experiences. This can be difficult, time-consuming, or incomplete. Context-aware AI systems may help by using user-approved personal context data, such as high-level location categories, time of day, activity patterns, media consumption history, photos, notes, or other information provided by the user, to generate reflective summaries, journal entries, visual artefacts, or guided reflection prompts.

This project combines and extends previous work on AI-assisted journaling and AI-assisted reflection on personal media consumption. For example, one type of system may help users write reflective journal entries based on high-level descriptions of places they visited during the day. Another type of system may help users reflect on patterns in their YouTube viewing history through AI-generated summaries, images, and guided reflection. The broader project may also include other related AI-powered systems for personal reflection.

Our goals are to understand how people use context-aware AI systems for personal reflection, how they interpret and revise AI-generated reflective outputs, what privacy and agency concerns they have, and how future systems can be designed to support meaningful, user-controlled, and privacy-conscious reflection.

This study is not intended to provide medical, psychological, therapeutic, legal, financial, or other professional advice.

5. Why have I been chosen to take part?

We are looking for adult participants aged 18 or above to try out prototype AI-assisted reflection systems and provide feedback on their experience.

You may have been invited because you may be interested in journaling, personal reflection, media consumption, AI tools, digital self-tracking, or trying new interactive systems. You do not need to have previous experience with journaling or AI tools unless a specific study activity requires it.

Depending on the specific prototype being evaluated, some participants may need to meet additional requirements. For example, a study on media consumption reflection may require participants to be users of a relevant media platform, such as YouTube, and to be willing and able to export or provide relevant media history data for the study session. A study on mobile context-aware journaling may require participants to carry a study smartphone or use a prototype app during a short deployment period.

We expect to recruit approximately 5–60 participants across one or more related study activities under this project.

6. Do I have to take part?

No. Participation is voluntary. You are free to decide whether or not to take part. If you decide not to participate, this will not affect your grades, academic standing, relationship with instructors, or access to university services. You are also free to withdraw from the study at any time without giving a reason and without incurring any disadvantage.

7. What will happen if I take part?

The exact procedure will depend on the specific prototype being evaluated. Before you consent, the researcher will explain the study activity and what it involves.

In general, participation may include:

1. Reading this Participant Information Sheet, asking questions, and completing a consent form. Depending on the study, you may be asked to provide separate consent for audio recording, screen recording, AI interaction logging, image processing, or use of anonymised examples in publications.
2. Completing a short pre-study questionnaire about your background and experience with journaling, reflection, AI tools, media platforms, or personal data tracking.
3. Using an AI-assisted reflection prototype. Depending on the study, this may be a context-aware journaling system, a media-consumption reflection system, or another AI-powered reflection tool. You

may review AI-generated outputs, interact with a chatbot or interface, revise generated content, and provide feedback.

4. Participating either in a single lab-based session (typically 45–90 minutes) or a field deployment lasting approximately one week to one month. During field studies, you may be asked to use the system for 5–15 minutes per day.
5. Allowing the system to collect research data such as interaction logs, prompts, AI outputs, edits, generated summaries or images, and reflective entries. Only data necessary for the research will be collected. Where possible, identifying information will be avoided, removed, or stored separately.
6. If relevant to the prototype, the system may process high-level contextual information (such as place categories or activity types), media-consumption data, or optional photographs. Exact GPS coordinates and raw media-history files will generally not be retained unless specifically required and explained to you. You will be advised not to provide unnecessary identifying information.
7. Completing a short post-study questionnaire and, optionally, a semi-structured interview about your experience, perceptions of the AI system, and suggestions for improvement. With your consent, interviews may be audio recorded and transcribed.

The total time commitment will typically be 45–90 minutes for a single-session study or approximately 3–9 hours spread across one week to one month for a field deployment study.

8. How will my data be used?

The University processes personal data as part of its research and teaching activities in accordance with the lawful basis of public task, and in accordance with the University's purpose of advancing education, learning and research for the public benefit.

Under the 'Data Security Law of the People's Republic of China' (中华人民共和国数据安全法) and the 'Personal Information Protection Law of the People's Republic of China' (中华人民共和国个人信息保护法), the University acts as the Data Controller for personal data collected as part of the University's research. The Principal Investigator acts as the Data Processor for this study, and any queries relating to the handling of your personal data can be sent to Brennan Jones (brennan.jones@xjtlu.edu.cn).

Further information on how your data will be used can be found in the table below:[BOOKMARK]

How will my data be collected?	We may collect brief survey or questionnaire responses from you, such as optional demographic and background information. We may collect audio recordings of interviews conducted during or after your participation, which may then be transcribed for analysis. We may collect researcher observation notes about how you use the prototype. We may collect screen recordings or screenshots of your use of the prototype, if you consent to this. These recordings may help the research team analyse how participants interact with the interface, review AI outputs, edit or revise generated content, and navigate the system. If screen recordings or screenshots contain identifying
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	details, these will be redacted before analysis, presentation, or publication where feasible. We may collect data generated through your use of the prototype system, such as timestamps, button clicks, navigation patterns, text entered into the system, AI prompts, AI-generated outputs, participant edits to AI-generated outputs, chatbot conversation logs, generated summaries, generated images, journal entries, reflection prompts, user feedback, and other system interaction logs. Depending on the specific prototype, we may also collect or process personal context data such as high-level location categories, time of day, user-provided notes, optional photographs, or media-consumption-derived information. The exact data collected for your study activity will be explained before you consent. For media-consumption studies, your original media-history file, such as a YouTube watch-history file, may be used by the system to generate outputs, but it will not be retained as study data unless this is explicitly described to you and you consent to it.
How will my data be stored?	The data will be stored in a secure internal cloud location (e.g., XJTLU Box) and may also be temporarily handled on XJTLU computers, researchers' computers, or external storage devices as needed for the research workflow. Physical data such as signed consent forms and paper notes will be stored in a locked filing cabinet in the PI's office.
How long will my data be stored for?	All data will be destroyed three years after completion of the research.
What measures are in place to protect the security and confidentiality of my data?	Only authorised members of the research team will have access to the research data. This may include the PI, named student researchers, and approved research assistants involved in recruitment, consent management, data collection, transcription, system maintenance, data cleaning, or analysis. Participants' signed consent forms will be stored separately from the main study data. Identifiable information will be removed or masked from the research data wherever possible. Participants will be identified in the study data only by an anonymous identifier such as "P1" or "P2." If you inadvertently reveal personal information during a session or conversation, that information will be removed or masked from the study data where feasible. Contact information collected for scheduling purposes, such as email addresses, will be used only for arranging participation, follow-up communication, compensation where applicable, and withdrawal requests.

	Audio recordings will be used only for transcription and verification. Screen recordings, screenshots, photographs, and generated images will be reviewed for identifying information, and identifying details will be blurred, cropped, redacted, or excluded from publication where feasible.
Will my data be anonymised?	The research team will de-identify your study data for analysis and reporting by removing or masking direct identifiers and replacing your identity with an anonymous participant code. However, some data collected may initially be linked to you for practical research purposes, such as scheduling and conducting the session, before those identifying details are removed. Because the study may involve audio recordings, screen recordings, free-text interaction with the prototype, AI interaction logs, personal reflection content, or personal context data, some data may initially contain identifiable or private information before de-identification is carried out.
How will my data be used?	The data will be analysed to address our research questions about how people use AI-powered context-aware systems for personal reflection. Questionnaire responses may be reported as descriptive data and may be analysed quantitatively where appropriate. Interview responses, observation notes, screen recordings, AI interaction logs, generated outputs, and other interaction data may be analysed qualitatively and, where appropriate, quantitatively. The findings may be used to improve the prototype, generate design recommendations, prepare student project reports or theses, and support academic publications or presentations.
Who will have access to my data?	Only members of the research team will be granted access to the data.
Will my data be archived for use in other research projects in the future?	No.
How will my data be destroyed?	At the end of the retention period, digital data will be permanently deleted from cloud storage. Any tracked local copies will also be permanently deleted. Physical data such as signed consent forms and paper notes will be securely shredded.

Use of AI and researcher access to interaction logs:

This study uses researcher-controlled prototypes that integrate AI models through API services, such as text-generation models, image-generation models, or other AI services. This means that you will normally interact with a research prototype, not with your own personal ChatGPT account or another public chatbot account.



The research team controls the participant-facing interface, interaction workflow, prompts, and system logging. The prototype may log your interactions for research purposes. These logs may include timestamps, button clicks, navigation events, context summaries, text entered into the system, AI-generated outputs, edits you make to AI-generated content, generated images, generated summaries, chatbot messages, journal entries, and other system interaction events.

Access to these logs will be limited to authorised members of the research team, including the PI and designated researchers involved in data collection, system maintenance, data cleaning, and analysis. Logs will be stored using pseudonymous participant IDs wherever feasible. Direct identifiers will not be intentionally included in AI prompts or interaction logs, and any identifying information accidentally entered by participants will be removed, masked, or redacted where feasible.

The prototype may use third-party AI services, such as OpenAI GPT models, OpenAI image-generation models, Qwen, DeepSeek, or similar services, depending on the specific prototype being evaluated. Some study activities may also use Tencent Meeting's AI transcription service to transcribe recorded spoken responses, if you give permission for this.

Where supported by the AI provider's terms and settings, participant inputs will not be used to train the provider's underlying AI models. However, because the underlying model and API infrastructure may be operated by third-party providers, the research team cannot directly control all aspects of the provider's server infrastructure, data-handling practices, logging, retention, or processing.

For this reason, we ask that you do not include unnecessary personal, identifying, confidential, or highly sensitive information when interacting with the prototype or speaking during recorded study sessions. The research team will manually review transcripts and study data to remove identifying information where feasible after collection.

AI-generated outputs may be inaccurate, incomplete, biased, or not fully representative of your experiences. You should treat the system as a research prototype that may support reflection, rather than as a reliable source of advice or an accurate interpretation of your life, behaviour, emotions, or well-being.

Transferring data outside Mainland China:

Some data generated during your use of the prototype may be electronically transferred outside Mainland China because some prototype systems may make API calls to third-party AI services, such as OpenAI models, including GPT and image-generation models. Depending on the specific system, data may be transferred to servers located in regions such as the United States or other regions where relevant AI or cloud providers operate.

The research team will avoid sending identifiable participant information to these services and will limit the data sent to only what is needed for the prototype to function. Direct identifiers such as your name, email address, phone number, student ID, account identifiers, precise address, or exact GPS coordinates will not be intentionally sent to third-party AI providers unless explicitly required for a specific prototype and separately consented to.

Where possible, raw personal data will be transformed into less identifying contextual descriptions before being sent to AI services. For example, exact GPS coordinates may be converted into high-level place categories such as "coffee shop," "library," or "supermarket"; media history may be transformed into derived metadata, summaries, or selected content titles rather than unnecessary raw files; and free-text entries may be reviewed, edited, deleted, or redacted where feasible.



Data will be sent through secure encrypted API connections where possible. You will be informed before participation about the specific AI tools used in your study activity and any relevant overseas data transfer.

9. Expenses and / or payments

You will receive ¥60 RMB, or an equivalent amount, for each hour of participation. For example, if you participate for 30 minutes, you will receive ¥30 RMB or equivalent.

For a single-session study lasting approximately 45–90 minutes, you will receive compensation based on the actual expected or completed time commitment for that session.

For a field deployment study, compensation will be calculated based on the expected study time, which may include an introductory session, daily app use, and a final interview. The exact payment amount for the specific study activity will be explained before you consent.

You may be reimbursed in cash, by bank transfer, mobile payment, or as a gift card, depending on the study arrangement and your location.

10. Are there any risks in taking part?

There are no expected risks beyond those encountered in normal use of digital systems and everyday life, but there are some possible inconveniences or minor risks to be aware of.

Because the system uses generative AI, the summaries, journal entries, images, chatbot responses, or other reflective outputs it produces may sometimes be inaccurate, incomplete, biased, or may misrepresent aspects of your experiences or data. Some AI-generated reflective content may also feel emotionally uncomfortable, upsetting, or unpleasant to you.

Because the study may involve personal reflection, some of the content you create or discuss may feel private. The study is not intended to ask about highly sensitive topics such as medical conditions, trauma, sexual behaviour, religious beliefs, illegal activity, or other topics likely to cause distress. You should not enter highly sensitive personal information into the prototype systems.

Because the study may involve screen recording, screenshots, audio recording, AI interaction logs, or personal context data, there is a privacy risk associated with collecting records of your interaction with the prototype. The research team will reduce this risk by minimising the data collected, using participant codes, storing data securely, restricting access to authorised researchers, and redacting identifying details where feasible.

Because some prototype systems may use third-party AI services, some of the data needed for the system to function may be processed by third-party providers, including providers outside Mainland China. The research team will reduce these risks by minimising the data sent, avoiding intentional transmission of direct identifiers, and advising you not to enter unnecessary personal, identifying, confidential, or highly sensitive information.

If you experience any discomfort or disadvantage as part of the research, please let the researchers know immediately.

11. Are there any benefits in taking part?

There are no guaranteed direct benefits to participating in this study, beyond getting to try out a novel AI-assisted personal reflection system and having an opportunity to reflect on your experiences, activities, habits, goals, media consumption, or other everyday behaviours.

The broader benefit of the study is that it may help researchers design better AI systems that support meaningful, privacy-conscious, and user-controlled personal reflection.

12. What will happen to the results of the study?

You may request access to your data by contacting the Principal Investigator, Brennan Jones (brennan.jones@xjtlu.edu.cn).

We may publish or present research reports or presentations of the findings of this research, including data collected from you. Any reports that include your data will be presented in an anonymised or de-identified format, and you would be referred to using an anonymous identifier such as “participant P1.”

Anonymised quotations, screenshots, examples of AI-generated prompts, examples of AI-generated images, generated summaries, or examples of participant-edited reflective content may be used in research outputs only where identifying information has been removed or masked and where you have consented to this use.

The findings may be disseminated through academic conference papers, journal articles, posters, workshop papers, student project reports, theses, and research presentations. Participants may request copies of publications or reports resulting from the study.

13. What will happen if I want to stop taking part?

You can withdraw at any time, without explanation. Results up to the period of withdrawal may be used if you are happy for this to be done. Otherwise, you may request that the results are destroyed and no further use is made of them, simply by letting us know before the data are anonymised.

Please note that your data may only be withdrawn prior to anonymisation. Once the data have been anonymised and/or aggregated for analysis, it may no longer be possible to identify and remove your individual data.

14. What if I am unhappy or if there is a problem?

If you are unhappy, or if there is a problem, please feel free to let us know by contacting Brennan Jones (brennan.jones@xjtlu.edu.cn) and we will try to help. If you remain unhappy or have a complaint which you feel you cannot come to us with then you should contact the Chair of the University Research Ethics Review Panel at ethics@xjtlu.edu.cn. When contacting the University Research Ethics Review Panel administrators, please provide details of the name or description of the study (so that it can be identified), the researcher(s) involved, and the details of the complaint you wish to make.

15. Who can I contact if I have further questions?

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16. Thanks



Thank you for your interest and your participation in this study!

